THE INVOLUNTARY MUSICAL IMAGERY SCALE (IMIS)

Do you have a tune stuck in your head?

This experience is also known as involuntary musical imagery (INMI) or "having an earworm". An earworm is a short section of music that comes into your mind without effort (it is involuntary; i.e. it comes even though you did not have any intention to retrieve or remember the music) and then repeats by itself spontaneously (i.e. without you consciously trying to replay the music) at least once, on a loop. It may have words or it may just be a melody or a rhythm.

The Involuntary Musical Imagery Scale (IMIS; section B), shown below, is used to study this experience and consists of 15 items. Two additional items (16, 17) are used to measure INMI duration independently of the IMIS.

For each item there are 5 possible responses. Please write a number next to each statement, from the scale shown above the items, that best describes your earworm experience. Before continuing to the IMIS, please first complete the statement in Section A. **If your response is "Never" then please do not complete the rest of the questionnaire.**

A.

1 Never	**2** Once a month	**3** Once a week	**4** Several times a week	**5** Several times a day	**6** Almost continuously

On average, I experience earworms: _____

B.

IMIS

1 Never	**2** Not very often	**3** Sometimes	**4** Most of the time	**5** Always

_____ 1. Earworms help me when I'm trying to get things done

_____ 2. It worries me when I have an earworm stuck in my head

_____ 3. When I get an earworm I move to the beat of the imagined music

_____ 4. My earworms agitate me

_____ 5. Personal issues trigger my earworms

_____ 6. I wish I could stop my earworms

_____ 7. The way I move is in sync with my earworms

_____ 8. I find my earworms irritating

_____ 9. When I get an earworm I try to block it

_____10. My earworms result from unresolved matters

_____11. I find my earworms help me focus on the task that I'm doing

_____12. The experience of my earworms is unpleasant

_____13. The rhythms of my earworms match my movements

_____14. I try hard to get rid of my earworms

_____15. The content of my earworms mirrors my state of worry or concern

16. On average, my earworm (the section of music that is stuck) lasts: _____

a. Less than 5 seconds
b. Between 5 and 10 seconds
c. Between 10 and 30 seconds
d. Between 30 seconds and 1 minute
e. More than 1 minute

17. On average, one earworm episode (a period of time when one particular tune gets stuck) lasts: _____

a. Less than 10 minutes
b. Between 10 minutes and half an hour
c. Between half an hour and 1 hour
d. Between 1 and 3 hours
e. More than 3 hours

Please check: Did you write a number/letter for each statement?

IMIS Scoring:

Negative Valence: 2, 4, 6, 8, 9, 12, 14

Movement: 3, 7, 13

Personal Reflections: 5, 10, 15

Help: 1, 11